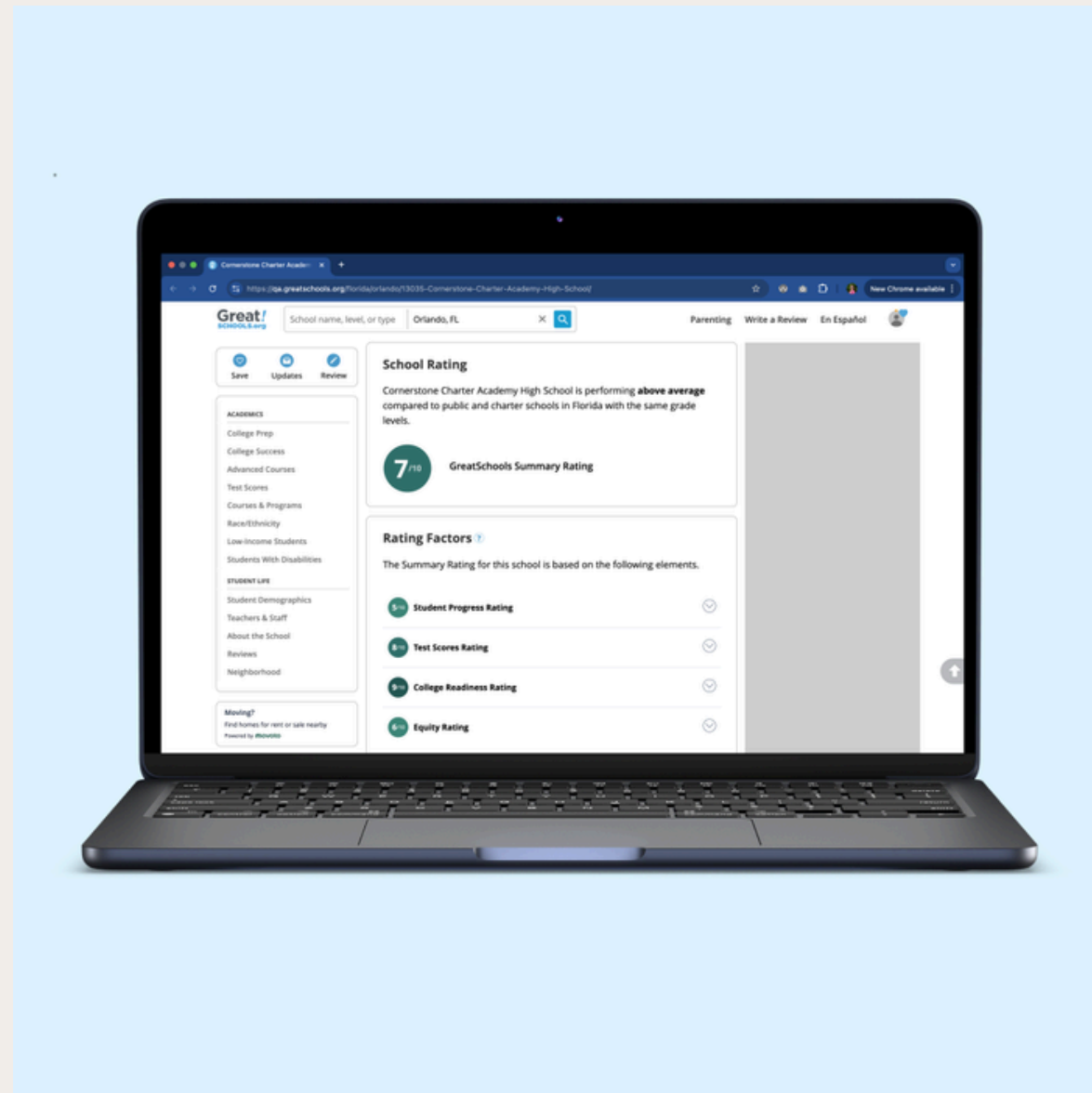


K-12 SCHOOL RATINGS



SUMMARY

1:1 user interviews designed to get quick and clean insights about what information users need to understand school ratings, and whether that information in a prototype is understandable.

IMPACT

Rolled out of improved product lead to

- 📊 80% decrease in frequency of user misunderstandings
- 📈 16% year-over-year increase in clicks on school profiles

CONTEXT & RESEARCH PLAN

Company	GreatSchools.org
Role	Lead UX Researcher
Timeline	Three weeks
Stakeholders	Product Manager, Data Scientist, Designer



Problem

- 1.Engineering planned to make school profiles more interactive in order to increase ad revenue and gather more usage data.
- 2.Stakeholders were confident our ratings were easy-to-use for parents.
- 3.But previous research suggested parents are sometimes unsure, sometimes misinterpret school ratings, like “8/10 test scores”.

Research questions

- 1.What information about school ratings is needed to pick a school?
- 2.Is that information easy to comprehend?

My approach

Scoping

- Asked stakeholders about their concerns during Zoom calls.

Method

- 1:1 user interviews, x3 design iterations
 - What questions would you ask about these ratings to decide if you would consider this school?
 - For each question, shared a drafted answer and got feedback.
- Recruitment
 - Parents in the US who were sending their kid(s) to a new school in the fall.

Analysis

- Matrix analysis in Google Sheets.

Collaboration

- “Soft-launching” insights in Confluence to prevent PM from being blindsided.
- Shared final report in a slide deck.

FINDING	RECOMMENDATION	IMPACT
One answer was disappointing - users didn't want schools to be compared across the entire state.	Out-of-scope for this project, but change the roadmap to move away from state-wide ratings to more local options.	• Small-scale and large-scale changes are in progress and in the backlog - unfortunately both are under NDA.
Some answers were understandable, but led to new questions.	Use a progressive disclosure interface to guide users away from "rabbit holes."	Rolled out in September 2024 to 500k unique monthly users • 80% decrease in frequency of user misunderstandings in usability testing. • 16% YoY increase in clicks on school profiles in actual use.
One new question came up.	Draft new content, conduct usability test.	
Clear understanding of what data is needed for users' jobs-to-be-done.	Decision to move forward with prototype a design, build it, and roll out the new version.	